

ROBERT SCHMITZ

INSTRUCTIONAL DESIGNER — CURRICULUM AND ASSESSMENT SYSTEMS

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SUMMARY

Instructional designer and doctoral student in Curriculum and Instruction (UCF) who builds the systems a course runs on: standards-to-objective curriculum maps, modular Canvas course architecture, and assessment item banks at scale. Built inside the classroom for ten years, then adopted well beyond it.

#1

PROFICIENCY RATE IN THE DISTRICT
FOR THE ASSIGNED COURSE LEVEL

3

FLORIDA DISTRICTS: MARION, POLK,
HILLSBOROUGH

10+ yrs

TEACHING AND LEARNING DESIGN

EXPERIENCE

Mathematics Instructor / Instructional Designer | 2019 – Present

Marion County Public Schools — Belleview High School. Teaches all levels of Algebra and Geometry.

- **Course architecture:** Built and maintains the modular Canvas courses for Algebra and Geometry — sequenced modules, embedded assessment, study guides, and instructional video that carry the course asynchronously.
- **Item banks at scale:** Authored assessment items aligned to Florida B.E.S.T. standards and course objectives, organized into reusable Canvas item banks that return instant feedback and on-demand practice.
- **Curriculum mapping:** Wrote the curriculum maps those courses run on, decomposing state standards into measurable objectives, learning progressions, and the performance evidence required for each.
- **Adoption beyond one classroom:** Produced a Canvas course with an integrated study guide that now circulates countywide, giving other teachers a ready-built path for state-assessment preparation; co-curated alternative course versions with peers.
- **Evidence-driven revision:** Reads state assessment results, district benchmarks, formative checks, and Canvas reporting to locate misconceptions, then rebuilds the material that produced them.
- **Educator enablement:** Facilitates district in-service and virtual professional development on curriculum design, standards implementation, and Canvas course development.
- **Game-based practice:** Builds review activities in Blooket, Gimkit, and Desmos Classroom off the same objectives and item banks as the graded assessments, so practice and measurement stay aligned.
- **Results:** The department holds the county's highest mathematics learning gains and overall scores; individually holds the district's highest proficiency rate for the assigned course level.

AI IN PRACTICE

Applies AI-assisted workflows to the production side of the work above: drafting and screening item-bank questions against the standard and the objective they are meant to measure, generating aligned practice and feedback variants, turning standards documents into first-draft curriculum maps, and templating Canvas modules so a new course starts from a working skeleton. Output is reviewed against the learning objective before it reaches a learner. Doctoral coursework specializes in instructional design, with applied focus on agentic AI workflows for curriculum production.

DESIGN METHOD

ANALYSIS AND DESIGN	ADDIE and Dick & Carey applied to course builds: analyze audience and standards, write measurable objectives, design the assessment that proves them, then build the instruction that gets there.
MODULE STRUCTURE	Gagné's Nine Events for sequencing within a module; UDL principles for access, multiple representations, and multiple means of demonstrating mastery.
LEARNING PROGRESSION	Moves learners from concrete interaction to representational analysis to abstract reasoning, with purposeful practice and immediate feedback at every step.
EVIDENCE	State assessment data, district benchmarks, formative checks, and LMS reporting drive revision of the materials themselves, not only of delivery.

LEADERSHIP AND SCALE

LEAD TEACHER	Bellevue High School. Mentors teachers and contributes to curriculum and assessment design for the mathematics department.
DISTRICT FACILITATOR	Leads in-service and virtual professional development sessions for educators across the district.
STANDARDS LIAISON	Attends Florida B.E.S.T. standards training and translates the implementation guidance into resources peers can use.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Mathematics Instructor | 2017 – 2019*Polk County Public Schools — Jere L. Stambaugh Middle School*

- Taught grades 6–7 mathematics through LMS-delivered lessons, digital tools, and game-based applications, with materials differentiated by learner readiness.
- Partnered with instructional teams on curriculum-improvement work during a school turnaround effort focused on academic performance.

GED Instructor | 2015 – 2016*Hillsborough County Public Schools — Plant City High School*

- Designed cross-disciplinary instruction across multiple subject areas for adult learners with widely varied prior knowledge and primary languages, preparing them for GED proficiency testing.

TOOLS AND PLATFORMS

LEARNING PLATFORMS	Canvas LMS (courses, modules, item banks, reporting) · Desmos Classroom · Articulate Storyline
ASSESSMENT AND PRACTICE	Canvas item banks · Blooket · Gimkit · Quizizz
MEDIA AND WEB	YouTube · OpenShot · Adobe Photoshop · WordPress · Dreamweaver
PRODUCTION	Microsoft 365 · Google Workspace · storyboarding · content curation

EDUCATION AND CREDENTIALS

EDUCATION

Doctoral Student, Curriculum and Instruction*University of Central Florida · Specialization: Instructional Design***M.Ed., Mathematics Education***University of Central Florida***B.S., Social Studies Education***University of South Florida*

CREDENTIALS

Instructional Design Certification*University of Central Florida***Florida Professional Educator Certificate**

Mathematics 5–9 · Mathematics 6–12 · Middle Grades Integrated Curriculum · Social Studies 6–12

AFFILIATIONS

USF Alumni · Florida Education Association